minister of state for IT. Addressing some 450 of them via video conference, he asked them to explore the Indian banking system and make it a part of their business model. Media reports said that several Indian start-ups in the software-as-a-service (SaaS) sector as well as ones backed by start-up accelerator Y Combinator have been affected. As many as 60 of the latter held deposits over $250,000 each that are now stuck in SVB, reports said, adding that Y Combinator has submitted a petition to Yellen seeking relief. Nazara Technologies, a publicly-listed gaming firm, has said two of its subsidiaries have $7.7 million (Rs 64 crore) in SVB. Research firm Tracxn's data shows that SVB has invested in 21 Indian start-ups, including One97 Communications (which runs PayTM), Shaadi and Naaptol.

OVERSEAS FUNDS FLOWING INTO INDIAN START-UPS COULD FACE DELAYS GIVEN THE LIKELIHOOD OF INCREASED SCRUTINY OF START-UPS

"There won't be too much direct impact in India," says a banking source. "In India, we do not have banks only for start-ups. Normally, a large part of the start-up funding comes under SME financing." Moreover, those directly impacted are companies registered in California. However, both US and Indian banks will become more cautious now regarding funding start-ups, he says. Overseas funds flowing into Indian start-ups could also face delays given the increased scrutiny. This will prolong the funding winter that start-ups currently find themselves in and hinder their expansion plans. ■

KERALA

SAFFRON SEEKS NEW PASTURES



NEW COURSE Amit Shah with BJP state leaders at the Janshakti Yatra flag-off, Mar. 12

ANI

By Jeemon Jacob

The BJP's impressive showing in the recent assembly elections in the Northeast—and the show of support by the Christian majority there—has raised the hopes of the party's Kerala unit. The state is an outlier, resisting the wiles of the saffron party, and Prime Minister Narendra Modi admitted on his visit on March 2 that breaching the gates was top priority. "It happened in the Northeast and Goa, and it will happen in Kerala too. The BJP will come to power here and become a real alternative for the people of Kerala. For years, the minorities have been threatened [by other political parties] invoking our name. But after Goa and now the Northeast states, the Christian brothers are with the BJP. The people of Kerala have realised the duplicity of the Congress and CPI(M)...they are doing *kushti* (wrestling) in Kerala and friendship in Bengal and Tripura," PM Modi said, blasting the state's two main parties.

Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan of the CPI(M) was quick with his retort, saying the PM shouldn't waste so much time "daydreaming". "The minority communities here know they are being persecuted by the Sangh Parivar everywhere in India, they will not fall for the